

Chapter 149_1 - Revenge

The next day's weather was somewhat gloomy. The clear moonlight from last night was blocked by dark clouds at dawn, which also blocked the morning glow, leaving everything in dim darkness until morning.

Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate awakened in such morning light. Bird calls pierced the sky, and Ning Fuyi suddenly woke from her bed with a start. When she turned and landed on the ground, the tear stains at the corners of her eyes were not yet dry.

Her mind was still half-unclear, and she knelt in place for a while. Only when all of yesterday's memories flooded into her mind did she panic and run toward the door.

She even forgot to use her immortal power, only focusing on using her legs. She nearly tripped twice when leaving the door.

The fear in her heart reached its peak the moment she stepped out of Jingshan Palace. She didn't know what scene she would see—perhaps the ghost fire had already died out, perhaps the sunlight was just right—but regardless of which it was, either would completely cast her into hell.

"Chu Qing..."

She crossed the threshold and suddenly stopped, her hair swinging across her cheek with her movement, leaving clear pain.

"Chu Qingqiu?" Ning Fuyi held her breath and stepped forward to grab the woman's sleeve, walking to her front.

The pleasant fragrance, the familiar face—Chu Qingqiu had not died. Only now did Ning Fuyi seem to learn how to breathe, gasping for air in large gulps, stepping forward to pull the person into her embrace.

But she quickly stopped, because she saw Chu Qingqiu's complexion—ashen and withered, with faint moisture circling around her eyes.

"What's wrong?" Ning Fuyi carefully gripped her shoulders. Seeing that she didn't answer, she turned her head to look in the direction Chu Qingqiu was staring at. There was nothing there, only the darkest mass of thick clouds above.

"What exactly is wrong?" Ning Fuyi blocked her gaze and asked again.

Only then was Chu Qingqiu awakened by her call. Her gaze looked toward Ning Fuyi, her eye sockets visibly tinted with scarlet, like blood-stained gardenia petals, leaving only desolation.

She raised her hand to tightly grasp Ning Fuyi's arm, as if seeking support, and spoke in a low voice.

"Qiu Yi..."

Her voice was as calm as possible, but the sorrow could still be heard from the trembling tail note: "Where is Qiu Yi?"

Ning Fuyi didn't know how to answer her words. She opened her mouth but made no sound.

The cliff at the peak of Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate was not far in front of Cloud Deep Hall, standing upon layered peaks. Looking down, one could overlook the eighteen mountain peaks. It used to be the disciples' favorite place for meditation and cultivation.

But today, not a single person dared to approach. Everyone stood silently behind the cliff, saying nothing, feeling the increasingly strong wind and the raindrops already faintly mixed within it.

After Chu Qingqiu arrived, all the disciples stepped aside to make way for her. So she stopped and walked through the crowd with an expressionless face.

Ning Fuyi followed behind her. When the heavy shadows all dispersed, everything on the cliff came into view.

That scene was shocking. Ning Fuyi averted her gaze, unable to suppress the bitterness in her heart.

Sobbing sounds occasionally arose from the crowd. The people didn't know what had happened, but this didn't prevent them from feeling sadness upon seeing that thin figure.

Green robes hung down at her sides. The woman sat cross-legged facing the mountains. One of the two curved blades that never left her hand was inserted into the ground, while the other was pierced into her own heart.

Blood flowed down from the blade tip that protruded from her back, staining a small cluster of grass leaves red.

Chu Qingqiu walked toward her figure step by step, lips pressed tight, expression wooden.

Halfway there, her legs went weak. She immediately staggered a step, and Ning Fuyi quickly sent out a stream of immortal power. The immortal power wrapped around her waist like wind, steadying her.

Then Ning Fuyi stepped forward and offered her palm, but Chu Qingqiu shook her head in refusal.

Chu Qingqiu walked around to the front of the woman. The woman no longer had breath, and all color had faded from her face. Those usually bright eyes were tightly closed, with a smile that had not yet dispersed at the corners of her lips.

The moment Chu Qingqiu saw her face, the immortal power in her hands could no longer be suppressed. White light burst from her palms, instantly blasting a distant mountain peak into pieces, with flying rubble.

Ning Fuyi trembled all over.

She had seen Chu Qingqiu's expression like this once before—when she had fallen into the tiger's den. The usually cold and indifferent woman's eyes were filled with ruthlessness, the corners strikingly red.

It was the same now. The cold air around her caused other disciples to retreat one after another, not daring to approach.

At this moment, the crowd was suddenly pushed apart again. A woman in red robes squeezed through the crowd. Upon seeing Qiu Yi's figure, she was stunned like them, standing in place without moving for a long time.

"Ning Fuyi..." She spoke tremblingly, as if seeking confirmation from Ning Fuyi about something.

Ning Fuyi shook her head at her and turned away, no longer daring to look at her expression.

Although Ning Fuyi didn't understand exactly why, at this moment she had a vague guess in her heart.

What followed next verified her guess.

Suddenly, thunder rumbled in the sky, then scattered raindrops fell from the dark clouds, hitting people's scalps with a chill. Then the rain intensified, and the sound of rain hitting mountain stones and tree leaves arose, drowning out the disciples' whispered conversations.

The ghost fire on the distant mountain peak seemed to sense something and suddenly blazed fiercely. Even though there was nothing around that could burn, flames still shot skyward in an instant.

The watching disciples cried out in alarm, pulling their companions to rush over, but were attracted by the scene on the cliff and stopped again.

They saw Chu Qingqiu suddenly draw a formation in mid-air. The heavy rain soaked her hair and clothes, but she didn't use immortal power to block the rain. Instead, she let the water wash over her face, only completing those cumbersome lines with stern eyes.

"Look, Qiu Yi's body!" A disciple suddenly pointed ahead and shouted. Everyone looked and was shocked to discover that the body of the woman who had been sitting on the cliff had somehow become transparent.

Jiuying's eyes reddened. She couldn't help stepping forward, but was held back by Ning Fuyi grabbing her wrist.

"What did she say to you?" Ning Fuyi asked.

"She said..." Jiuying looked at Qiu Yi's increasingly unclear silhouette and murmured, "She said she was the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase¹."

Ning Fuyi's eyes widened.

At this moment, the formation in Chu Qingqiu's palms was completely finished, and Qiu Yi's body was left with only a shadow, taking the shape of gardenia flowers before scattering in the wind.

Thus, that final physical body transformed from a single flower petal of Chu Qingqiu's, along with the woman who had once called out "Divine Venerable" with eyes full of devotion, quietly disappeared.

A tear fell from the corner of Chu Qingqiu's eye. Then she opened her mouth, and an ethereal voice came from beyond the heavens, chanting ancient divine language that few could understand.

The moment the words ended, another shadow emerged from the formation—a palm-sized green jade vase with a smooth, lustrous body. Ancient inscriptions were carved around the mouth, emitting scattered points of light.

The moment the vase came into being, violent winds suddenly arose all around, swaying everyone left and right. More reckless raindrops struck heads and faces with thumping sounds, leaving everyone present in a sorry state.

Chu Qingqiu then changed her hand gesture, pointing both fingers toward the jade vase, and said in a low voice: "Suppress."

Then they saw the jade vase suddenly rise into mid-air. The mouth shone brilliantly like the sun and moon, tilting toward the ghost fire. Then strong winds arose, and suddenly fragrance descended from heaven and earth—that fragrance was secluded and calm, a scent none had ever smelled before.

The urgent raindrops suddenly transformed, becoming like spring rain in the third month, fine and moist as cream. Where the rain sprinkled, everything burst with life—withered grass turned green, dead trees bloomed with flowers.

The dying Wuji ghost fire in the distance, after touching the gentle rain threads, immediately withered like a fire with its base removed. Finally, it turned into a wisp of green smoke and vanished without a trace.

The disciples watching all this were dumbfounded. After realizing what had happened, several people immediately felt relieved, while the rest still stood stunned until someone spoke.

"Was that just now the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase?"

"Qiu Yi, was Qiu Yi the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase?"

As soon as they finished speaking, the dark clouds overhead seemed to tear open from the middle. Dazzling sunlight poured down through the cracks onto the mortal world. The previous violent storm instantly turned into gentle wind and beautiful sun.

Only the crowd was left standing wetly on the cliff, looking at each other.

Some wanted to celebrate that the threat of the ghost fire had finally been eliminated, but suddenly remembered the dead Qiu Yi. Their smiles froze on their faces, and soon only deathly silence remained among the crowd.

Sunlight fell on Chu Qingqiu. The warm light replaced the wet cold. Chu Qingqiu silently landed, and the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase also withdrew its radiance, returning to normal shape, spinning as it fell toward her.

It landed steadily in her palm.

Without need for any contract, it recognized her as master.

Footnotes:

1. **Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase (玉净开云瓶)** - A powerful immortal artifact capable of purifying evil energies and controlling weather phenomena. As revealed in this chapter, Qiu Yi was actually this legendary artifact in human form.